Puberty: The Game Show

By Greg Atkins

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: ***Actress*** *-- Babs, Elana, Karen, Tommy's Date, Pimples, Rapper #1*
Actor *-- Alan, Tommy, Mother, Pimples, Rapper #2, Beatboxer*

BABS: [And we're on in five, four, three, two, and…] **(Pg 7-8)** Welcome to . . . Puberty! *(applause)* The show that leads you through the most exciting, frustrating, exhilarating, frightening, and embarrassing time of your life! *(applause)* Puberty! And now, the hosts of Puberty! Alan Beckman and Elana King! *(Alan and Elana walk out and take their places – applause)*

ALAN: Thank you, thank you everyone! Well, Elana, you look very nice today.

ELANA: So do you, Alan.

ALAN: Oh, this? It was a hand-me-down from my older brother. *(laughing)* I'm used to it. I was thirteen before I got my own toothbrush.

ELANA: *(laughing)* Oh, gross.

ALAN: And how about you? I understand you have been very busy.

ELANA: Yes, I've just released my very own brand of perfume.

ALAN: Congratulations, Elana! *(He claps)* What is the name of this wonderful fragrance?

ELANA: Elana Wanna. It tells the boys, "Here I am!"

ALAN: That sounds great! Are you wearing it right now?

ELANA: Yes. *(leans forward for Alan to smell)*

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ALAN: *(not pleased with the smell) (chokes)* Pungent! Well, I guess we had better get on with it and introduce our first two pre-pubescence contestants.

BABS: Hailing from Portsmouth, New Hampshire, a state famous for producing Bauxite, please welcome Tommy Landry! *(Tommy enters to applause)* And from Oxnard, California, the vacation playground of migrant farm workers, let's put our hands together for Karen Stiver! *(Karen enters to applause)*

ALAN: WELCOME TO… PUBERTY!

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS: *Everyone's been through the change!*
ACTOR: *The only thing different about this sudden morph into adulthood is that it's done on a gameshow.*
ACTRESS: *Join your hosts and the contestants on a wild ride in*
TOGETHER: *Puberty: The Game Show by Greg Atkins.*

ALAN: **(Pg 8-14)** Alright, but before we begin, let's find out a little about our contestants. Karen, let's start with you. I understand you are in the seventh grade.

KAREN: Yes, I am, Alan. I go to Heinekin Middle School. *(She turns to the television audience and cheers)* Go Weevils! My parents are divorced, I live with my mother and see my father on weekends and I have a dog named Bosco and a little brother I hate.

ALAN: Sounds good.

ELANA: And what about you, Tommy?

TOMMY: I'm Tommy Landry and I go to Our Lady of Perpetual Motion Catholic School in Portsmouth. I'm in the seventh grade and my school just went

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co-ed this year, which is okay I guess. My parents have been married for twenty years and I have an older brother, Kevin, and a younger sister, Patty. I like computer games and baseball and my best friend is Chuck. *(He waves at television audience).* Hi, Chuck.

ALAN: It looks like we've got two live ones, Elana.

ELANA: It sure looks that way, Alan.

ALAN: Are you ready to get on with Puberty?!

KAREN: Yeah! **TOMMY:** Let's do it. *(simultaneously)*

ALAN: Alright, let's get you all set up while Elana explains the rules. Elana?

ELANA: Thank you, Alan. After picking a card from Alan, our contestants must move the number of spaces designated on the card. Wherever our contestants land on our Puberty Path they must follow the instructions corresponding with the square they land on. Each square holds something new and different for our contestants. Whether it's Most Embarrassing Moments, Hormone Hijinx, or My Parents Will Kill Me, every square moves you further along the path of Puberty! And remember, each square gives you the opportunity to get Adulthood Points. The more points you get the easier it is to pass through Puberty.

ALAN: Don't forget to mention the Experience Circle.

ELANA: How could I forget that? In order to score extra Adulthood points, the contestants have the option of entering the Experience Circle where they must actually deal with an incident in their growing up process. If they deal with the Experience well, they get those valuable extra points, if they don't they could lose everything. It's a risk, but, hey, what in life isn't a risk?

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ALAN: Confusing? Of course it is, it's Puberty!

ELANA: Are we ready, Alan?

ALAN: Are you ever ready for Puberty, Elana? Of course not. But if you're asking if we're ready to play . . . contestants are you ready to play Puberty?!

KAREN AND TOMMY: YEAH! *(Game show music from Babs)*

ALAN: Then let's get started! And since girls seem to begin Puberty before boys, who are we to go against nature? Karen, you go first. Do you choose the green card or the red card?

KAREN: The red card. *(She takes the card and moves 3 squares)*

ELANA: And you've landed on the The Parent Trap. Do you want to go for a three point Question or the six point Experience?

KAREN: I think I'll take the Question to start out with.

ELANA: Alright, here it is. You are asked to the movies by Tom Child!

KAREN: I am!?! Oh my *gosh*, oh my *gosh*! He's in the ninth grade and on the basketball team!

ELANA: Your Question is: Do your parents let you go?

KAREN: *(A pause)* Yes, they have to let me go, I'll die if they don't let me go! Yes, yes!

ALAN: *(Buzzer from Babs)* So sorry, Karen. They say you're too young to date and anyway the movie was rated NC-17, they'd have never let you in.

KAREN: I hate my parents. I hate them!

ALAN: Of course you do, it's Puberty! Now on to Tommy. Pick a card.

TOMMY: Red, please, Alan.

ALAN: Red it is. And you move one square.

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ELANA: You land on Hormone Hijinks. Would you like the three point Question or the six point Experience?

TOMMY: Hormone Hijinks? I better go with the Question.

ELANA: Alright, it's a multiple choice and here it is: Your voice is beginning to change and the first time it happens you are: A - Singing in the shower. B - Talking to the guys after you lost a baseball game. C - Talking to Becky Casey in Math class. Or, D - in front of the entire English class during your oral report?

TOMMY: Ummmmm?

ALAN: You only have fifteen seconds, Tommy.

TOMMY: D. During my oral report?

ELANA: *(Ding-ding-ding! - Bell from Babs)* That's right! That's good for three Puberty points!

ALAN: And back to you, Karen. Red or Green?

KAREN: Green.

ALAN: Move ahead one.

ELANA: And it's back to The Parent Trap. Experience or Question?

KAREN: I think I'll go for the Experience.

ALAN: Then let's go! *(he takes her center stage)* You know how this works, you get to live the Experience and if the judges feel you have moved ahead in your growing up process, you get the six Puberty points and move into the lead. Got it?

KAREN: Yeah.

ALAN: *(moving back)* Take it, Elana.

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ELANA: Thanks, Alan. Your category is The Parent Trap and your Experience is: Coming Home Late.

KAREN: Oh, no.

MOTHER: *(A studio audience member assumes the role of "Mother" walks into the experience circle)* Hello. Or should I say, Good morning?

KAREN: Mom, I can explain.

MOTHER: 12:16. 12:16 on a school night? When is your curfew?

KAREN: Mom, look, I -

MOTHER: Answer me! When is your curfew?

KAREN: 9:00 on weeknights, 10:00 on weekends? . . . We didn't leave the library until 9

MOTHER: So it took you three hours to get home?! *(Screams in frustration, then takes a calming breath)* Karen, I want to trust you -

KAREN: You can!

MOTHER: But you make it so hard sometimes. This is why I won't even entertain the thought of you dating! *(Pause)* So what am I supposed to do?

KAREN: Ground me, I guess.

MOTHER: I guess you're right! Curfew is now 8:00 - *(Karen is about to interrupt)* - and you are grounded for two weekends!

KAREN: But . . .

MOTHER: Three weekends.

KAREN: That's not . . .

MOTHER: Four weekends! Wanna try for five? *(Karen fumes silently)* Alright, up to bed.

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ALAN: *(Ding-ding-ding! – Bell from Babs)* And there's the bell! Good for six points! Congratulations!

KAREN: I can't believe it! Grounded for four weekends?! This sucks!

ELANA: And one extra weekend of restriction for having a potty mouth.

ALAN: You'd think she'd learn, wouldn't you, Elana?

ELANA: Yes, Alan, you'd think she would. Well, Tommy, here's your chance to really rack up some points. Step on up.

TOMMY: A red card, please.

ALAN: The red card says… move three spaces!

ELANA: **(Pg 19-21)** And you've landed on Those Magic Moments.

ALAN: Question or Experience?

TOMMY: I'd better go for the points. Experience

ALAN: Then let's go! *(Alan hands Tommy a baseball mitt)* [I hope you're good at baseball.] *(Tommy enters the Experience Circle in the middle of a baseball game)*

TOMMY: Oh, my *gosh*. Here it comes. I gotta catch it. Don't panic, it's just a game. Just the difference between being a social outcast and a hero. *(he readies himself to catch a pop fly)* Where is it? It's in the sun! Ah, ah! AHHH! *(catches ball – the bell rings then Tommy drops the ball – The buzzer sounds)*

ALAN: Oh, too bad Tommy! No points.

TOMMY: I'm gonna be a social defect. No one on the team will ever talk to me again.

ALAN: Well, we can only imagine the ridicule and embarrassment you are going to have to endure for the rest of your life.

ELANA: Luckily, we can only imagine it, you have to live with it. Now on to Karen.

ALAN: Red or green, Karen?

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KAREN: Green, Alan.

ALAN: And it's a big move -- five spaces!

ELANA: And you land on… oh oh, "Mother finds your diary!" And reads all your complaints about her. Too bad.

KAREN: Stupid diary! Stupid Mom!

ALAN: Too bad about your diary. Get up here, Tommy! Pick a card, buddy.

TOMMY: Red!

ALAN: You move two spaces!

ELANA: And land on first love! Question or Experience?

TOMMY: Well, Elana, I better go for the 6-point Experience.

ELANA: Alright, your category is first love and your Experience is First Kiss.

TOMMY: FIRST KISS?!? Oh, man! This is gonna make me nervous.

ALAN: Head on over to the Experience Circle. *(Tommy steps in and a member of the studio audience assumes the role of his date – they are walking up to her front porch at the end of their first date)*

TOMMY: **(Pg 24)** So you liked the movie?

DATE: I told you I liked the movie four times. I liked the movie. Why are you acting so weird?

TOMMY: I guess because it's our first date. I want everything to be perfect.

DATE: It has been perfect. *(each look away from each other, then Date applies Chapstick)* Well… here we are. I had a wonderful time tonight.

TOMMY: So did I. *(Both lean in for a quick kiss and porch light turns on. Both jump back.)*

DATE: It's okay. It's just my mom flicking the porch light on and off. It means I have to go in.

TOMMY: Oh, well then, goodnight *(he starts to leave)*

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DATE: *(She grabs his arm)* Hey, didn't you forget something? *(She pulls him to her and they kiss) (Ding-ding-ding!)*

ALAN: And six points for Tommy!

BABS: *(beedeeepbobbityboop)*

ELANA: [Looks like we'll have to take a quick break. Here's] a word from our sponsor.

COMMERCIAL BREAK

PIMPLES: **(Pg 26-30)** *(Both actor and actress sing/rap together)* We are your pimples, we live upon your face, we are happy pimples, you'll find us everyplace. We are nasty pimples, you'll never get rid of us, we are pus-filled pimples that erupt like Vesuvius.

RAPPER 1: Not so fast. *(Pimples gasp)*

BEATBOXER: *(creates beat for Rappers to follow during next song)*

RAPPER 2: What you need is a Zip-Zap Pad, the best friend you ever had.

RAPPER 1: Just wipe it all along your face and pimples leave without a trace.

RAPPER 2: Now that your skin is looking hot, you can go back to eating chocolate.

RAPPER 1: Fries and chips and all things bad.

RAPPER 2: Just thank your handy Zip-Zap Pad.

BEATBOXER: Zip-Zap Pads come in Padettes, Extra Strength pads and full body wraps -

RAPPER 1: - from AmWay

TRANSITION BACK TO THE GAME SHOW

BABS: And we're back in five, four, get ready, two and… *(Babs points to Alan)*

ALAN: Well, Elana, we're almost through Puberty! Boy what an exciting show we're having today.

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ELANA: You're right, Alan. As the score now stands: it's Karen with [6] points and Tommy with [9], and it's Karen's turn.

ALAN: Right you are. Karen pick a card, if you please.

KAREN: I pick green, Alan.

ALAN: And it's another five spacer! You land on Unexpected Turn of Events.

ELANA: That also puts you near the end of Puberty! Question or Experience?

KAREN: I'll take the Experience.

ALAN: If you get this Experience correct, you will take the lead. Your Category is Unexpected Turn of Events and your Experience is: What Do They Really Think? *(Karen steps into the circle and pulls Tommy in with her)*

TOMMY: Whoa - what's going on? This isn't my Experience.

ELANA: Actually, Tommy, this Unexpected Turn of Events is partially YOUR experience.

KAREN: Where are your parents? *(Karen's inner voice)* He looked so cute when lost at Puberty.

TOMMY: They're finishing signing some papers so I can get my prizes. *(Tommy's inner voice)* I can't believe she reached Puberty before I did!

KAREN: These game shows show really give you nice parting gifts. (Karen's inner voice) I think he's still upset. I kinda like him.

TOMMY: Yeah. *(Tommy's inner voice)* Yeah, you get to go through puberty and I get the home version, plus a year's supply of zit pads. *(to Karen)* Well, I gott ago.

KAREN: Don't you need my phone number? *(Karen's inner voice)* I wonder if I should kiss him.

TOMMY: Sure. *(Tommy's inner voice)* Oh, man this stuff makes me nervous.

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KAREN: It's J-K-L-M-N-O-P. *(Karen's inner voice)* Let's see if he can figure it out.

TOMMY: 555-6667? *(Tommy's inner voice)* Good work, Tommy! *(to Karen)* Karen . . . *(Tommy leans over and kisses her on the cheek) (Ding-ding-ding!)*

ALAN: Six points for Karen! And that final bell tells us we're out of time! So the score now stands with [nine] points for Tommy and [twelve] points for Karen!

ELANA: Which means, Karen, you've made it through Puberty! *(Karen screams, giggly excitement)*

ALAN: Congratulations, Karen. You are embarking on an exciting 'next step' in your life - Young Adulthood. Looking forward to it?

KAREN: *(excited)* I sure am, Alan. *(Tommy looks defeated. During this next section to the end, Tommy pouts and looks angry, Karen waves to audience members and blows kisses at people)*

ELANA: Well, Tommy, you're no doubt a bit disappointed, but don't worry! We have some lovely parting gifts! Tell us about them, Babs.

BABS: Tommy will receive a case of Zip-Zap Pads, a bottle of Elana Wanna and the home version of Puberty!

ALAN: So this is Alan Beckman -

ELANA: - and Elana King -

ALAN: saying Join us tomorrow

ELANA: - because no one wants to go through Puberty alone!

BABS: **(Pg 31)** All contestants are under medical supervision while going through Puberty. And don't forget t o play Video Puberty! By Nintendo. Now you're playing with Power!

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2004 National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
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Cutting compliments of
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**With minor adjustments by the 4N6 Fanatics staff to ensure correlation with the original text.*

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